

Seared king salmon with piperade Basquaise and lemon

Serves 4 as part of a shared meal

4 x 150 g king salmon fillets, skin on, pin-boned
Salt and pepper
Olive oil
4 lemon cheeks

Piperade Basquaise

2 red capsicums
2 yellow capsicums
4 tomatoes, blanched and peeled
100 ml olive oil
2 brown onions, julienned
4 garlic cloves, julienned
4 sprigs thyme
Salt and pepper

1. To make the piperade, peel the capsicums with a vegetable peeler. Cut the flesh from the core in 3–4 large pieces. Remove the white ribs from inside the capsicum fillet pieces, and slice lengthwise into 3 mm strips.
2. Cut the tomatoes into quarters, then remove the seeds and core. Slice the tomato flesh into 3 mm strips.
3. Warm the olive oil in a wide-bottomed saucepan over a low heat. Add the onions, garlic and thyme, with a pinch of salt to help the onions soften. Cook for about 30 minutes, stirring frequently, until the onions and garlic are very soft but have no colour to them.
4. Add the capsicums and continue to cook for another 20–30 minutes until they are very soft, then add the tomatoes and cook for another 10 minutes.
5. Season to taste. Remove the thyme stalks before serving. If planning to serve this dish the following day, leave the thyme